Effective Presentations

Source:
https://www.unh.edu/student-success/sites/default/files/media/2022-07/resources-effective-presentations-writing.pptx

“Great speakers aren’t born, they are trained.”

Presenting is a skill developed through *training* and *experience*

Agenda

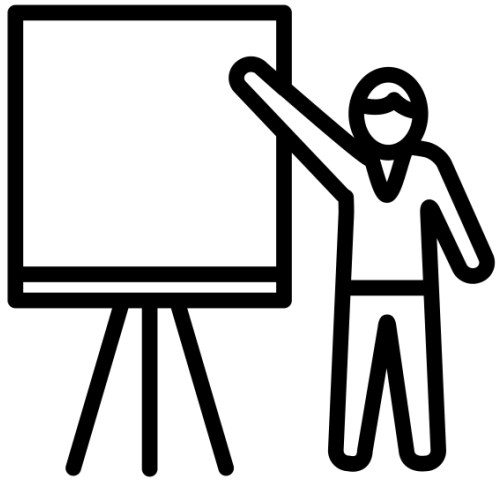
- Introduction
- Planning your presentation
- Presentation sequence
- Creating effective visual aids
- Effective presentation techniques

Introduction

Why give a presentation?

Main Purposes:

1. Inform
2. Persuade
3. Educate



Definitions

Presentation

> “Something set forth to an audience for the attention of the mind”

Effective

> “…producing a desired result”

Public Speaking, A Common Fear

- Feared more than death!
- Often experience:
  - Shaky hands
  - Blushing cheeks
  - Memory loss
  - Nausea
  - Knocking knees
- All completely **normal!**

Some Causes of Presentation Anxiety

- Fear of the unknown OR loss of control
- No backup plan
- No enthusiasm for subject
- No confidence

Creating Effective Presentations

- Control anxiety – Don’t fight it
- Audience centered
- Accomplishes objective
- Conducted within time frame
- Fun for audience
- Fun for you!

Planning Your Presentation

Planning an Effective Presentation

1. Determine purpose - What do you want to accomplish?
2. Know your audience! - Success depends on your ability to reach your audience
    - Size
    - Demographics
    - Knowledge level
    - Motivation
    - Why are they attending?
    - What do they expect?

More Planning...

3. Plan space accordingly:

- Number of attendees and seats
- Seating arrangement
- Lighting & lighting controls
- Audio & visual equipment
- Any distractions

4. Think about what day and time:

- Morning
- Afternoon
- Evening
- Work day vs. weekend
- Any day!

… and More planning!

5. Organization

- Determine main points (1-5)
- Evidence
- Transitions
- Prepare outline
- Prepare a storyboard

6. Rehearse!

- In the actual room (if possible)
- Follow a script and time your presentation
- Practice Q & A
- Check all equipment and devices
- Make contingency plans

Organizing Your Presentation

Organizational Patterns:

- Topical
- Chronological
- Problem & Solution
- Cause & Effect
- Same as paper/thesis

Presentation Outline/Style

- Keyword reminders
- Conversational flow
- Flexibility
- More responsive to audience

The Presentation Sequence

1. Build Rapport



- Relation marked by harmony or affinity
  - Audience members need to trust you & feel that you care about them
- Start before you begin
  - Mingle, learn names
  - Opportunity to reinforce or correct audience assessment
  - Strong first impression
- People listen to people they like

2. Opening Your Presentation

- Introduce yourself
  - Why should they listen
- Get attention, build more rapport, introduce topic
  - Humor
  - Short story
  - Startling statistic
  - Make audience think
  - Invite participation
- Get audience response

3. Completing the Opening

- Clearly define topic
- If informative…
  - Clear parameters for content within time
- If persuasive…
  - What's the problem
  - Who cares
  - What's the solution
- Overview

4. Presenting Main Points

- Make point → transition … make point → transition … make point → transition …
- Include supporting evidence
- Use examples
- Feedback & questions from the audience
- Pay attention to and focus on audience, are they listening?

5. Concluding Presentation

Goal:

- Inform audience that you're about to close
- Summarize main points
- Something to remember, or call-to-action
- Answer questions

Creating Effective Visual Aids

Designing Good Slides

- Content
  - If it doesn’t add value, don’t say or use it
- Color
  - Know the room and lighting
    - Dark room - light font on dark background
    - Bright room - dark font on light background

Content

- Purpose
  - Complement speaker
  - Talk ≠technical report
- Density
  - 7 - 10 lines / page (for 16:9 only)
  - 4 - 8 words / line (for 16:9 only)
  - Test : Project a sample in the room, or in a room of approximately the same size as will be used in the real presentation

Visual Aids

- To make, emphasize or identify a point
- To emphasize, clarify, or reinforce a point
- To remind, summarize or review a point
- We remember:
  - 10% of what we read
  - 20% of what we hear
  - 30% of what we see
  - 50% of what we see and hear

Visual Aids

- Enhance understanding
- Add variety
- Support claims
- Lasting impact

When used poorly, however, they can be a distraction and lead to an *ineffective* presentation

Visual Aids

- Powerpoint slides
- Overhead transparencies
- Graphs/ Charts
- Pictures
- Web links
  - http://www.unh.edu/uacc/unhpathways.html
- Films/video
- Flip charts
- Sketches
- Chalk or whiteboard

Visual Aids Should…

- Outline, explain, support main points
- Serve audience’s needs, not speaker’s
- Be simple and clear
- Supplement and support… not dominate the presentation!

Making Text Visible

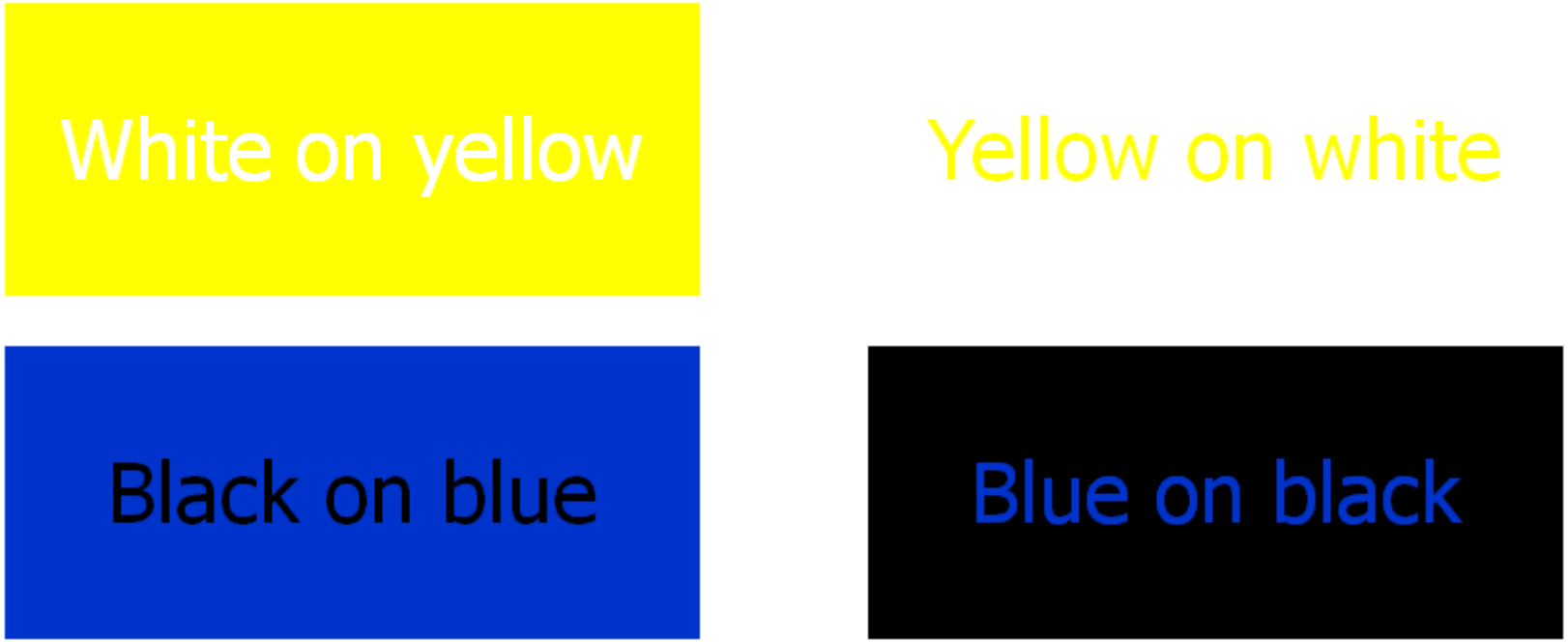
- Use Sans Serif fonts (fonts without feet)
  - ex - Arial, Tahoma, Trebuchet, Verdana
- Titles should be 32-44 pt. Font size, **bold**
- Text should be as large as possible
  - First level 24 - 32 pt font size
  - Second level 20 - 28 pt font size
- Use color wisely
  - Contrasting colors

Red / Blue Conflict





Low Contrast



“Fly - In” vs “Wipe”

Could you read this?

How about this one?

Maybe the third time is the charm!

Less distracting

Reduces eye movement

Increases readability

Be **consistent** throughout!

Effective Presentation Techniques

What Makes an Effective Speaker?

- Control of information
- The voice used
- The right words
- Use of body language
- Prompts, scripts and notes
- The right location
- Useful and meaningful visual aids

Vocal Techniques

- Loudness
  - Will you be using a microphone?
- Pitch
  - Vary to make points
- Rate
  - Watch your audience
- Pause for effect
  - Allow time for message to “sink in”
- Deviate from the norm for emphasis

The Voice

C: Clear - the use of simple, easily understood words and phrases

L: Loud (enough) - it is important everyone can hear you

A: Assertive - a bright and confident air born of knowledge of the subject and good preparation

P: Pause - it is essential to allow the listeners time to digest what you have said

Using the Right Words

The key to a successful presentation: ***What you say*** and ***how you say it***

P: state your position or **p**oint

R: explain your ideas

E: use **e**xamples

P: restate your position or **p**oint

Body Language

- Make eye contact, but move focus around the audience
- Use your hands, but don’t go crazy
- If possible, move around, but slowly!
- Maintain good posture
- Don’t speak with your back to the audience

Scripts and Notes

- Learn and use a script for formal presentations to large groups
- ~~Small note cards~~, or PPT notes page, can be used, but FIRST write a script
- Underline key words that will best remind you what you want to say
- ~~Use one card for each slide or topic~~
- ~~If possible, have someone else advance slides for you~~

Speaker Reads Slides

- A speaker may put his entire presentation on his slides. He turns his back to the audience and reads the slides aloud. Perhaps he feels this approach guarantees all the information will get to the audience.
- This may be the most annoying way to give a presentation. Audience members feel insulted: they already know how to read! They wonder why the lecturer doesn't simply hand out a copy of the slides.
- The visual presentation dominates the presenter. The presenter is not adding any value to what is on the slides.

Pssst - This slide is way too busy!

Common Problems

- Verbal fillers
  - “Um”, “uh”, “like”, “you guys”
  - Any unrelated word or phrase
- Swaying, rocking, and pacing
- Hands in pockets
- Lip smacking
- Fidgeting
- Failure to be audience-centered

Pauses

- Useful
  - Awaiting thought
  - Switching gaze
  - Reading slide
  - Reinforcing point
- Powerful
- Difficult

Control of Information

- Know your subject well
- Know what you are talking about
- Practice
- More practice
- More rehearsals
  - In front of the mirror, colleagues, friends, or family members
- Believe in yourself
- Know your opening by heart

Closing Summary

- Audience is always attentive at the beginning
- Somewhat less attentive in the middle
- Generally more attentive at the end
- Tell them what you are going to say
- Then say it
- At the end, say it again
- Allow time for questions

Questions & Answers

Opportunities

- Welcoming gestures
- Focusing gaze
- Body language
- Getting point
- Reinforcing message
- Including audience

Pitfalls

- Hostile gestures
- Wandering gaze
- Body language
- Missing point
- Seeking approval
- Excluding audience

5 Presentation Tips

1. Smile
2. Breathe
3. Water
4. Notes
5. Finish on, or under time

Summary

Guide audience gently

Design slides carefully

Use pauses effectively

Answer questions inclusively

Thank you!

Questions?